

TOP
FLOOR

written by
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an ambitious manhattan **doorman**

moves into the **penthouse** of his dreams

only to be **trapped** in a dangerous new identity

Open on the Pyramid House.

22 luxury stories over a manicured slice of Manhattan. This late, most lights are out. Except two penthouses up top.

And a green marble lobby down below.

Out front, a parked sedan faces away from the building.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - NIGHT

Two skeptical eyes monitor the Pyramid through the mirrors.

SERA (PRE-LAP)
Maybe it was Murry.

SERA (30s) squeezes a juicebox in her mouth, splattering RED on her sweatpants. She checks the backseat for a wetwipes.

SERA (PRE-LAP)
But that makes no sense to me.

Meanwhile, in the:

REARVIEW MIRROR

A BODY DROPS from the top of the Pyramid and--
SPLATS onto the street.

INT. NYPD - INTERVIEW ROOM - HOURS LATER

REVEAL two DETECTIVES interview Sera, in stained sweatpants.

SERA (CONT'D)
It's not who he is.

The Detectives exchange an incredulous look.

DETECTIVE 1
When did you see him last?

SERA
I want to see him now.

She rises with a huff--

DETECTIVE 1
Sera. We need your help.

--but doesn't leave.

Grabs her tote bag. Digs in: Goldfish, no. Applesauce, fine.
She struggles to open the package...pulling and stretching...

SERA
Two weeks ago.

DETECTIVE 2
And? Where was he two weeks ago?

...until finally RIPPING it open.

SERA
Two weeks ago, he was still living
in my basement.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - BASEMENT - DAY (TWO WEEKS EARLIER)

MURRY (24) lays face-first on the concrete floor.

SERA (V.O.)(CONT'D)
But things were looking up.

He raises himself into a pushup. By his side, an Android
phone plays "MORNING PUSH - UNLEASH POTENTIAL".

WORKOUT VIDEO
--and down. Feel the resistance.

He flattens again, dense beard dripping sweat.

SERA (V.O.)
To him, they always were.

WORKOUT VIDEO
Now close the gap. Eyes up.

He pushes up, leaving a face-shaped sweat-stain.

SERA (V.O.)
That's what you need to know about
my brother. He didn't get "down".

Cranes his neck to a CRACK OF LIGHT. The room seems to SHAKE--

SERA (V.O.)
Not since before he was even Murry.

--until:

SERA (O.S.)
MURAT!

sends him FLOPPING onto the concrete.

ONE: **BOTTOM**

Murry turns his head up to the:

KITCHEN

where Sera's yelling down the stairs at him.

SERA (CONT'D)
You better be dressed!

HUSBAND (O.S.)
Don't talk to him like that.

Her HUSBAND counsels in a preschooly tone while feeding their TODDLER, as if to impart a lesson. Sera mimics him:

SERA
How else am I supposed to talk?

HUSBAND
With respect.

SERA
Respect the NJ Transit schedule.

MURRY (O.S.)
I have 16 minutes.

Murry emerges in a doorman uniform. Pours powder into a glass of water. Stirs. Chugs...as Sera suppresses her judgment.

SERA
I'll drive you to the station.

MURRY
I walk in 11.

SERA
But breakfast--

MURRY
I'm on a mineral fast.

He pops an earbud in and heads out. She shouts after:

SERA
Those people aren't doctors! And
don't be late tonight!
(under breath)
He listens to anything anyone says.

Husband discreetly mouths to the Toddler: "not anyone".

INT./EXT. NJ TRANSIT - DAY

Murry stands all the way to Manhattan. Letting others take the seats. A testosterone-fueled podcast in his ear:

PODCAST (EARBUD)

The person you want to be is the person you are now. Your job is to find the difference and act, before the door of opportunity closes.

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - DAY

Murry opens the door for wealthy, mostly elderly residents. No one really looks at him. But he always smiles. Genuinely.

HOURS LATER

Murry heads to the elevator...and confidently presses UP.

MURRY

Barry I'm on break!

PENTHOUSE FLOOR

DING! Murry steps off softly. Checks both ways. Then unlocks:

PENTHOUSE B

BARK BARK BARK as Murry slips inside.

SNACKS (11, blind but limber) is going crazy. Barking and spinning. Sniffing Murry, investigating him...until Murry pours a bowl of food. As Snacks digs in...

...he inspects luxurious details: mounted speakers, a working fireplace, and an oak-framed oil painting of Icarus's wings.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - CONTINUOUS

Murry waltzes out through glass french doors.

The deck, shared with Penthouse A, is split by hedges. The view, straight to the park, is spectacular. But Murry isn't looking at the city below his feet...

...he's filling a SYRINGE with clear liquid.

TITLE:

TOP
FLOOR

He flicks the needle.

An air bubble rises...escaping into the sky.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - DAY

Murry steps off the elevator...

BARRY (O.S.)
That's 16 minutes, Murry. PTO
doesn't start until Monday.

...right into burly building manager BARRY - who sniffs.

BARRY (CONT'D)
And what's this smell?

Murry proudly presents his wrist as they walk.

MURRY
Do you like it?

BARRY
It doesn't matter if I like it. All
scent profiles must be Board
approved. On-skin or in-home. You
know this. It's in the binder.

MURRY
Juju has the binder.

BARRY
And many residents have allergies.

MURRY
But do you like it or not?

BARRY
This is about safety. Not the--
(sniff)
Fuzzy peach with a splash of--
(sniff)
Jasmine?

Murry smiles. He *does* like it! Then he SNIFFS. Oh no.

MURRY
Is that--

BARRY
Your problem tonight.

Murry looks at his watch: 5:00pm.

MURRY
But I have a dinner thing at 7.

BARRY
And I have a note from my doctor.

Murry takes a breath and proceeds alone to the:

FRONT DESK

where CYNTHIA of 21C holds a casserole of dubious content.
She's springy for eight decades, but wields an ivory cane.

CYNTHIA
Made your favorite, Murphy.

MURRY
That's so sweet, Ms. Wax. Maybe
Barry wants some too?

CYNTHIA
Barry brought a note.

Cynthia points to the casserole: *go ahead.*

CYNTHIA
Poor thing's been complaining about
his system for weeks now. I
referred him to Ross Flicker...

Murry peeks at the clock as he takes the fork, then watches
helplessly as Cynthia settles on a guest bench...

CYNTHIA
...you know Ross. Or maybe he was
before your time. Excellent GI but
quite *uncooperative*. *The man wore
flip-flops to a board meeting...*

*...and unloads a full clip of grievances. There are no
breaths or pauses for Murry to say he has to go. It's a
shellshocked haze of complaints and casserole until--*

DING!

Murry sprints to the door in anticipation of:

VALERIE of PENTHOUSE A emerging from the elevator.

But the vivacious 55-year-old stops to look down on Cynthia - who's 20+ years her senior, but lives one floor below.

VALERIE

What are you feeding this poor boy?

CYNTHIA

It's called "casserole", Valerie. I always forget you never had a family to cook for.

VALERIE

I mean his shift ended 40 minutes ago. What are you droning on about?
(turning to Murry)
Let me guess: the new recovery center for at-risk teens.

Cynthia plants her cane in the floor and rises with fury.

CYNTHIA

It's a literal drugstore by our home. We're the ones at risk!

Valerie's delighted she took the bait. It's a game to her.

VALERIE

Cynthia. It's their home too.

CYNTHIA

Oh shove it in your NPR tote bag. Those "kids" are not from here. They could be dangerous.

VALERIE

Please. The only dangerous people in this neighborhood are upstairs.

The Co-Op Co-Presidents lock eyes. Two grizzled veterans of uptown real estate wars. Murry can taste the tension. And it tastes like Cynthia's casserole. Then, suddenly...

...they both start LAUGHING. Loudly.

Unsure what to do, Murry laughs too. Fear in his eyes.

HA HA HA HA

THE DOOR OPENS!

On its own! That's not supposed to happen! Murry races over, but not before--

An elegant shadow of a man spreads over the lobby floor...

VALERIE
Nikki.

CYNTHIA
Nikos.

This is NIK of PENTHOUSE B...

MURRY
Sorry, Mr. Lamb.

...though we can't see his face yet. Just a graceful wave that puts Murry at ease. But not Cynthia.

CYNTHIA
I assume you've gotten our emails.
(pointing cane at Nik)
And don't you dare blame this on
"spam" again. I know that's baloney.

VALERIE
Cynthia. This is hardly the venue.

CYNTHIA
This entire building is my venue. I
am President of the god damn co--

VALERIE
Co-President. And I insist we save
this discussion for our next
meeting. He's clearly busy anyway.

CYNTHIA
Busy with what?

NIK (O.S.)
Murry.

Murry looks up to Nik. He always has.

NIK (O.S.)
Do you have something for me?

HALLWAY

Murry carries a delivery box, trailing Nik's tailored jacket.

NIK (O.S.)
Shouldn't Juju be here by now?

Murry balances the box, then knocks on the door to the:

STAFF OFFICE

where night doorman JUJU is playing games on his phone.

MURRY (O.S.)
Juju I'm leaving!

PRE-LAP: DING!

ELEVATOR

Doors open. Murry follows Nik inside.

NIK (O.S.)
Nice haircut by the way.

Murry touches his hair, touched he noticed. And for the first time today, someone looks Murry right in the face, revealing:

Nik's face. His haircut almost exactly the same as Murry's. In fact, the two bear a striking resemblance.

Doors close. And the two of them rise together.

PRE-LAP: BARK BARK BARK

PENTHOUSE B

Snacks sniffs excitedly at Nik's feet.

NIK
Thanks again for the help with
Snacks today. How was everything?

Murry sets down the delivery box. But stays in the hallway. Gently intercepting Snacks before he can venture out.

MURRY
Two cups Purina, 12 units insulin.
And no one saw me come or go.

NIK
You don't need to be so sneaky.

MURRY
Barry told me a doorman got fired
for being in a unit unattended.

NIK
Must've been before my time. But
I'm here now. Why don't you come
inside for a bit?

Murry looks at his feet. The line between the hall and the unit. It was one thing when he was alone. But with Nik actually here, it feels more...intimate.

NIK
Come on. I've had a hell of a week.
You're not in a rush, are you?

BUZZ. Murry quickly ignores a call from Sera. He is.

MURRY
Not at all.

Murry steps inside.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - NIGHT

Murry follows Nik to the edge of the deck. He takes in the view, leaning forward on a railing - which CREAKS.

NIK
Careful. Long way down from here.

Nik stares straight down at the asphalt. Something's wrong.

MURRY
Are you okay, Mr. Lamb?

NIK
You know, you're the only one who
ever genuinely asks me that?
(off his shock)
I mean it, Murry. People say "how
are you doing" without so much as a
question mark. But you...

Nik trails off. Murry opens to ask, but Nik gets there first:

NIK (CONT'D)
I'm fine. It's just work.

MURRY
I never asked what you did.

NIK
But you know.

Silence. But Nik SLAPS his back, LAUGHS. Leads him inside.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - CONTINUOUS

Nik pours two glasses of Ouzo. Hands one to Murry.

NIK
The money business may seem sexy.
But I'm just another middle man.

He drops back on the sofa with Snacks. Knocks back his drink. Gestures for Murry to sit, which he does.

MURRY

This doesn't look like the middle.

NIK

Depends where you're standing. But as you get older, it never feels like enough.

MURRY

Please. You're not that old. We look basically the same age.

NIK

That's very sweet of you, Murry. But it's just the money. Creams, sun, doctors. It's all a facade.
(turning to TV)
But I see how we might be mixed up.

Side by side in the TV's warped reflection, the two men are nearly indistinguishable.

NIK

You're like me with a fresh start.

Sigh. The liquor's loosening him up. But his glass is empty. He shakes the ice. Murry hands over his drink.

MURRY

You can have mine. I'm avoiding neurotoxins until I'm post-revenue.

NIK

Post-revenue? They don't pay you to be a doorman here?

MURRY

Well. I'm not a doorman. I'm an entrepreneur who opens doors.

NIK

(curious smirk)
Entrepreneur? You have a company?

MURRY

I have a pitch.

NIK

Then let's hear it!

Nik slaps Murry's leg. Finishes his drink. Murry lights up--

NIK (CONT'D)
Unless you need to be somewhere?

--but so does his phone. He *does* need to be somewhere.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME

Sera's call goes straight to voicemail as she cooks.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)
Who do you want to be?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Murry pitches to Nik.

MURRY (CONT'D)
How do you want to be known? There
is one sensation tied most tightly
to memory. To identity...
(pacing like he practiced)
Crafting a unique, non-fungible
fragrance is more than just an
investment in your *brand*. As a
tradable asset, it's an investment
in your *future*. So. Do you smell it?

Murry SPRITZES a bottle of fragrance in the air dramatically--

MURRY (CONT'D)
...the person you want to be?

--mist raining down on Nik. He COUGHS.

MURRY
Sorry. That's a prototype. But you
get the idea. Right?

NIK
Sure. It's like...*crypto cologne*.
Very interesting.

MURRY
Really? You're interested?

NIK
No, Murry. In this context,
"interesting" means *not interested*.

Murry mouths "interesting means not interested" to himself.

Nik gives him a look: *what was that?*

MURRY

I repeat things I want to remember
until I can write them down.

NIK

And I love that hustle. I do. But--

Nik gestures for him to sit. Murry stays standing, but sinks.

NIK (CONT'D)

But it looks like you know where
this is going.

MURRY

I want to hear it anyway.

NIK

Fine. This isn't Shark Tank. And I
don't do Venture Capital...but--

But? Murry's posture snaps back into place.

NIK (CONT'D)

But. I know VC folks. And I suggest
you orient the pitch *to them*. The
thing is, when you raise money,
you're not selling a product. You're
selling a *vision of the world* only
you can create. You understand?

Nik stands to pour himself another drink.

MURRY

Definitely. I'll be locked in on
this for the next two weeks.

NIK

Two weeks?

MURRY

Yeah. I have PTO starting Monday.

Nik pauses. Holding the bottle. Like he's stuck in place.

MURRY

Is everything okay, Mr. Lamb?

NIK

Nik.

Murry cocks his head. What?

NIK

It's Nik. And no. It's not.

Nik turns back with a big sigh.

NIK

Like I said, it's been a hell of a week. The market is *uncooperative*. And my clients are panicked - and scattered - *Santa Fe, Boca*. I've been trying to find time to visit them. But you know, Snacks...

The blind dog bumps into Murry's leg. Then nuzzles.

NIK

He's a good dog. But he's not *well*. And not just cataracts. The sitters keep screwing up his insulin. And those kennels and "dog hotels"? They won't even do the shots. But you, I can trust. And he trusts you too.

Eye contact. Nik is desperate. Snacks whimpers too.

NIK (CONT'D)

I wouldn't ask if it wasn't an emergency. I don't have any family. And I'll pay you, of course.

MURRY

And I'd love to help. Really. But my place doesn't allow pets.

NIK

Then stay here.

Murry blinks. What.

NIK

You've got two weeks. What better to place to work on the business? And when I'm back, maybe I can connect you to some VC contacts.

Nik disappears into the bathroom...

...leaving Murry lost in a glorious daydream.

INSERT - visions of lounging in the penthouse, working on his fragrances, and signing a deal on the dining room table.

NIK (O.S.)

So. What do you think?

BACK TO REALITY - Murry walks into the dining room table. Ow. He rubs his thigh and snaps out of it.

MURRY
I think I could lose my job.

NIK (O.S.)
No one's losing their job.

MURRY
But eventually *someone* will see me.

Nik finally returns with a RAZOR.

NIK
Not if they see me.

What.

Nik waits for this to land.

Murry sputters, turns to his reflection in a wall mirror.

NIK (O.S.)
Of course, we notice a difference.
Because we see our faces more than
anyone. But I'm sorry to tell you--

Nik appears beside him in the mirror. He's older. And shaved.

NIK (CONT'D)
No one else looks at you like that.
Not in this city. We're all just
shapes and shades to each other.

They are roughly the same shape and shade. Though Murry's bulkier, and that's accentuated by the beard.

NIK
Think about it. Do any of the
tenants ever even look at you?

MURRY
You do. And Cynthia stares above my
head sometimes when she's talking.

NIK
She's nearly blind *with* glasses.

MURRY
What about Valerie? She hired me.

NIK
And she leaves for the Hamptons
tonight. Until August.

Nik lets Murry digest. And then a final pitch:

NIK

I know this sounds crazy. But it's a win-win. Maybe even a miracle, if you believe in that sort of thing. Two weeks could be enough to save my fund. And maybe it's enough for you to, like you said, *start being the person you want to be.* This is the place to do that. And I am the guy you want owing you one.

(gently)

Don't let fear hold you back.

But that's not what's holding him back. BUZZ BUZZ. It's Sera.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Murry walks into a frantic scene. A cooking Husband, crying Toddler...and an angry sister.

SERA

You are very late.

MURRY

Did you already finish dinner?

SERA

No. She's late. We're doing coffee.

MURRY

So why are you mad at *me*?

SERA

You'd said you'd be here.

MURRY

She's the one who's not here.

SERA

That is not the point.

The Husband GRINDS BEANS. Sera shouts over it:

SERA (CONT'D)

And those are not the right beans!

Sera SLAPS the counter with a spatula. Husband stops.

MURRY

None for me, please. I'm phasing out neurotoxins.

Sera trains the spatula on Murry, threateningly.

SERA

We haven't seen Fatma Teyze in six years. You will sit with that woman and drink hot liquid. I don't care what chemicals it contains.

The Husband throws a supportive arm over her shoulder.

HUSBAND

She's your aunt, Murry.

SERA

She's not our real aunt.

MURRY

She's not our real aunt.

DING DONG!

Sera slips her Husband's hand off her shoulder with the spatula. Points it to the door: *get it.*

LIVING ROOM

Husband serves cookies to Sera, Murry, and FATMA (70s).

FATMA

Damatın çok efendi.

SERA

She says you're very polite.

HUSBAND

I know what she said.

(pleased, to Fatma)

Afiyet olsun, Fatma Teyze.

(Note: **bolded dialogue** = translated Turkish for subtitles)

FATMA

I'm surprised you still live here.

SERA

She's surprised we still live here.

FATMA

I thought a big shot writer like you would stay in the city.

Sera bites a dry cookie.

MURRY

What did she say?

FATMA

He doesn't speak Turkish?

SERA
That's what he says.

MURRY
 What did you say?

SERA
 She's surprised we still live here.

MURRY
 You already said that.

FATMA
Your aunt must hate the new design.

SERA
 Um. She said real Teyze must have
 complained about our redesign.

HUSBAND
 She died before we did it.

SERA
 I know. Give me a second.
 (thinking, then to Fatma)
Teyze died before we moved in.

FATMA
But she never left.

What? But before Sera can react, the KETTLE WHISTLES!

COFFEE TIME

They sip tiny coffee cups. Murry finishes in one swig, spits
 it in another cup. Fatma flinches – disturbed but intrigued.

FATMA
Let me read you.

SERA
No. Thanks, Fatma Teyze.

HUSBAND
 Let her do it. It's fun.

SERA
 Its witchcraft.

MURRY
 Just translate.

Fatma inspects the patterns of the coffee in Murry's cup.

FATMA

**Oh yes, Murat. We still talk about
you back home. *The boy who climbed
out of the earth.***

(beat, then to Sera)

Does he even remember?

SERA

He says he doesn't.

Murry nudges her. Before Sera can translate:

FATMA

**But you do, of course. Guilt is
such a loathsome burden.**

Sera clenches her teeth. Fatma turns back to Murry and the cup, tracing a jagged line of grounds from bottom to top.

FATMA (CONT'D)

**He has much ahead of him. But he
must be careful not to fall.
Miracles don't happen twice.**

Murry nudges Sera again. But she's thrown off.

SERA

She's talking about the shapes.

MURRY

It looks like an arrow.

SERA

Or maybe it's a Pyramid. Like the
building where you work.

FATMA

It will open only once.

SERA

She says be patient at work and
good things will happen.

MURRY

But what did she actually say?

FATMA

The door, Murat.

SERA

It's a door. You're a doorman--

MURRY

I'm not a doorman. I'm an--

MURRY
--entrepreneur currently
opening doors.

SERA
--entrepreneur currently
opening doors.

Her mockery hits him right in the gut. Which turns to anger.

MURRY
Why won't you tell me the truth?

SERA
It's not "the truth", Murry. It's
the imagination of an 80 year old
woman who believes in ghosts!

Sera rises fast, KNOCKING the cup to the floor.

Murry and Sera march out. Fatma stares at a black stain on
the carpet - shaped like a downward triangle. The Husband
doesn't understand what's going on, but tries to be polite.

HUSBAND
Basketbol sever misin?

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - DRIVEWAY - NIGHT

BOUNCE BOUNCE

Husband plays basketball with the Toddler and Fatma. It goes
as you would imagine. But he's really trying!

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - BASEMENT - SAME

BOUNCE BOUNCE

Above Murry's head, outside narrow windows: feet dance on
asphalt around a bouncing ball.

But he's not watching. He's tinkering with fragrances.

Gloves on, he removes a sample bottle from a large box
labeled FLAMMABLE. Tests it on his skin. SNIFF.

CREAK--

Murry hides the box under a blanket. Rips off the gloves and
pretends to meditate as--

SERA (O.S.)
I need to do laundry.

Sera clomps down the stairs without clothes. Eyes on her
Husband's happy feet through the window.

SERA
He's like a Labrador.

MURRY
Contentment is wisdom, Sera.

SERA
Don't do that.
(off his look)
Don't regurgitate podcast tidbits
at me like some elevated yogi.

MURRY
I wouldn't if you ever listened to
any of the episodes I send you.

BOUNCE. They pull back. She resets the tone as she tidies.

SERA
Listen. I know you've been working
hard at...*being realistic*. And I
know this isn't your dre--
(looking at pullout sofa)
--dream. But if you keep saving, I
really think you can have the whole
energy drink thing paid off in--

She TRIPS over bundle of hard blankets.

SERA (CONT'D)
What the fuck is this?

She unveils the box labeled FLAMMABLE. Murry rushes over to
check on the bottles inside.

MURRY
Expensive. Careful.

SERA
This is what you're spending your
money on? Cheap plastic bullshit
that'll set the house on fire?

MURRY
It's fragrance.

SERA
It smells like--
(sniffing bottle)
Bullshit! There's nothing in here.

MURRY
That's just the base. Members
customize their own unique blend.

Sera blinks. Speechless. Murry senses an opening...

MURRY

Do you want to hear the pitch?

BOUNCE. No.

SERA

You promised you'd focus on work.

MURRY

This is work. I have two weeks PTO
to stand up the business.

SERA

Business? It's another fucking
pyramid scheme. And I can't believe
I even have to say this, but Murry:
you are not the one at the top.

MURRY

You have no idea what you're
talking about. This is my concept.
Nobody's taking advantage of me.

SERA

Yet.

BOUNCE.

SERA (CONT'D)

But this is what always happens.
Someone sees that big stupid smile
on your face...they feed your
dreams, then leave you holding the
bag. That's what happened with the
Georgian yogurt guys. That's what
happened at the shore. And that's
what *just* happened at Rutgers.

BOUNCE.

MURRY

This is nothing like Rutgers.

SERA

Yes. It is. It's always the same.

BOUNCE bounce bounce into a dribble...

SERA (CONT'D)

You're always the same.

...and rolls into the basement window.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - LATER THAT NIGHT

Sera can't sleep. She pours a glass of water. But doesn't drink. Just gently opens the basement door...

SERA

Murry?

No response. She closes the door. Then she checks MESSAGES from Murry on her phone. Mostly podcast links from him. She opens "ACTIVATE AGENCY". But she doesn't even have the app.

NIK (PRE-LAP)

Murry...

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Foamy beard hair rains down the sink.

NIK (O.S.) (CONT'D)

What'd I tell you?

A HAND wipes steam off the mirror, exposing:

Murry, freshly shaven.

NIK (O.S.)

You're a miracle.

Another HAND wipes the rest of the mirror, revealing:

Nik beside him. Without the beard, the two are a close match. Except for Murry's broad shoulders and Nik's age/exhaustion.

NIK

My clothes might be snug. So treat yourself to something nice.

He sets down a black credit card. Heads out.

NIK (O.S.)

Can't wait to hear that new and improved pitch when I'm back.

LIVING ROOM

Nik finishes packing a bag and speaks loudly:

NIK (CONT'D)

In the meantime, just stick to his schedule and don't drop any food. He'll eat anything off the floor.

Snacks sniffs at Murry's suitcase and box of fragrances.
On top, Nik finds Murry's wallet. Inside:
Driver's license of Murat Oğan. Longer hair, bushy beard.

MATCH CUT TO:

MURRY'S SHAVEN FACE

in the bathroom mirror. Major difference from the license.

NIK (O.S.)
Be sure to try the glasses.

Murry puts on glasses. They blur the world a bit.

With the slight blur, he looks almost exactly like Nik.

NIK (O.S.)
And Nik?

MURRY
Yeah?

NIK (O.S.)
That was a test. Good job.

He hears the ZIP of Nik's bag.

NIK (O.S.)
I owe you my life.

Murry rinses out the sink and scurries to the:

LIVING ROOM

where he heads toward the door to say goodbye.

MURRY
See you in two weeks.

He stretches his hand out to shake Nik's.

But the door is closed. He pulls off the glasses and sees:

A mirror on the back.

He's looking at himself.

SERA (PRE-LAP)
Murry! Get up!

TWO: UP**INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY**

Sera shouts downstairs as her Husband feeds their Toddler.

HUSBAND
He didn't tell you?

Sera whips back to him. *Tell me what?*

BEDROOM

Sera quietly slams the door. Whisper-screams at her Husband as he calmly makes the bed.

SERA
What do you mean he "found a place"? He doesn't have any money.

HUSBAND
Maybe he has a friend.

SERA
You didn't think to ask?

HUSBAND
At 2am? I'm just trying to support--

SERA
Why can't you support *me*?

HUSBAND
This is supporting you, Sera. He's 24. You can't baby him forever.

SERA
I can if he acts like a baby. Our toddler shows better judgment.

HUSBAND
Can you please just find something else to focus on besides him?

SERA
I'm sorry. You think I'm *bored*? I have a child.

HUSBAND
And a husband who now works from home. Plus, we have my mom--
(off her scowl)

HUSBAND (CONT'D)

For emergencies. I just don't think it's the worst idea to have some type of...project to work on.

SERA

Like what, *baking bread*?

HUSBAND

Sera. You're a writer.

Sera grinds her teeth. *Not anymore.*

HUSBAND (CONT'D)

Because you don't write.

SERA

You sound like Murry.

HUSBAND

At least he knows who he is.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)

Nikos C. Lamb.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - DAY

Murry practices Nik's voice in the mirror.

MURRY (CONT'D)

But you can call me Nik.

With blurry glasses on: it's a perfect match. Without them: razor bumps cover his face. And Nik's sweater stretches at the seams on his shoulders, like a hand-me-down.

Snacks WHINES by the door.

MURRY

Relax, buddy. He'll be back in a few weeks.

Murry thinks. Then heads to the bathroom...

...returns with Nik's cologne. SPRITZ.

Snacks scampers over. SNIFFS. Then WHINES again. *Nice try.*

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - DAY

Juju opens the door for Murry and Snacks as they return from a walk. Juju gives him a respectful nod. Murry flushes with excitement. It's working!

ELEVATOR

Murry hits PH with pleasure. As the doors close...

AN IVORY CANE pierces the gap. DOORS POP BACK OPEN--

CYNTHIA steps in with scowl. Taps 21.

Doors close. And they rise together in silence...

...until she SNIFFS. Murry freezes.

DING! Doors open.

CYNTHIA

No need for so much cologne, Nikos.

(stepping off)

We can all smell the desperation.

DOORS CLOSE on his woozy face. Snacks whines. That was close.

PENTHOUSE B

Murry tinkers with a new formulation labeled "Nik". Snacks SNIFFS. Doesn't approve. Hm.

MURRY

I'll need to go downtown to get
different oils. You'll be alright?

INT. STORE - DAY

Murry shops for essential oils. Sniffing thoughtfully.

BUZZ. Text message from SERA: "Where are you?". Ignores it.

EXT. DOWNTOWN STREET - DAY

Bag in hand, Murry passes a brick building. Tiny sign reads: VILLAGE HOUSE. The logo matches a keyfab on Nik's keychain.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - DAY

A RECEPTIONIST at the front desk SNIFFS.

RECEPTIONIST

What is that? Is there a gas leak?

MURRY (O.S.)

Hello?

Finally, she notices:

Murry standing oddly at the end of the desk. Face covered in razor bumps. Clothes ill-fitting. Bag of mysterious bottles.

RECEPTIONIST

Hello. Hi. Um. Are you a guest? The club is member's only.

MURRY

I am a member. Nikos Lamb.
(raising keyfab)
Do I just tap here?

He taps a READER - GREEN LIGHT. Receptionist half nods.

RECEPTIONIST

I'll need to see some ID as well.

Just then, a MEMBER emerges from the door, taps his keyfab to a reader, and walks right in.

RECEPTIONIST (CONT'D)

Do you have your driver's license?

DING! A group emerges from the elevator across the lobby.

WENDY (O.S.)

Murry?

Murry freezes. Then bolts outside as a...

...woman his age (WENDY) emerges. Looking around. Confused.

INT. PYRAMID - ELEVATOR - DAY

Murry ignores a call from Sera. Hits PH. Doors close until...

FIVE RED FINGERNAILS slip between. Doors pop back open for:

Valerie dragging her luggage onto the elevator.

VALERIE

Afternoon, Nikki.

Doors close on his startled face. *Not again.* They go up.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

You look surprised to see me.

MURRY

Oh no. Um. I just thought you were in the Hamptons.

VALERIE
 There's a gas leak. I started
 seeing things. And the smell!

She SNIFFS. Murry goes white. But--

DING!

...she steps off and heads to Penthouse A without a word.

PENTHOUSE B

Murry gets Nik's voicemail. Before he can leave a message--

KNOCK!

Murry hangs up. Checks the peephole. No one's there.

But Snacks BARKS toward the glass door to the deck, where:

Valerie waits outside. Shit. Murry scurries to open up.

VALERIE
 What a day. Do you have wine?

She blows past him to the wine fridge. Inspects bottles.
 Murry chases behind. Before he can stammer out a response:

VALERIE
 What year is this one?

MURRY
 (checking label)
 Oh. Um. 2022?

VALERIE
 Good. Nothing he'll miss.

MURRY
 Who?

VALERIE
 Nik.

Murry cocks his head. Yes?

VALERIE (CONT'D)
 I didn't know you could read
 without your glasses.

Valerie UNCORKS the bottle.

Murry goes still. She inspects his silent face.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Otherwise, it's uncanny. Have you
two always looked this similar?

MURRY
Please don't fire me.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Settle down. We all know whose idea
this really was. And I suppose I'm
supposed to be at the beach?

MURRY
I'll tell him to come back.

He pulls out his phone, but she plucks it from his hand.

VALERIE
Don't make *me* the party pooper.
This all seems like a lot of fun.

MURRY
You're not mad?

VALERIE
Mad? Murry, I'm worse than mad.
(gesticulating, spilling)
I'm bored! This city in the summer.
It's municipal dramamine, darling.
And this little game of 'Guess Who'
is titillating! Look at my arm!

Valerie holds up goose bumps on her surprisingly toned arm.

MURRY
I'm just taking care of the dog.

VALERIE
And taking care of yourself.

Her fingers traces the stitching on his sweater, being
stretched tightly over his broad chest.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
But eventually something will
finally snap. Those poor fibers.
(heading for the door)
Come on, Saks closes at 9.

MURRY
Why are we going to Saks?

VALERIE
Because they know us at Neiman's.

INT. SAKS - MEN'S SECTION - LATER

Murry holds up an obnoxious sweater for Valerie's review.

VALERIE
Absolutely not.

MURRY
But it's Gucci.

VALERIE
It's garbage, darling.
(ripping it away)
Wealth is a language. And these
logos are practically screaming.

DRESSING ROOM

Murry peels the curtain to reveal a new outfit to Valerie.

VALERIE
Now we're talking. You're like a
whole new man.

Murry pulls out Nik's credit card, but she pushes it away.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Oh no. This is my treat. It's so
fun dressing you up. Like my doll.

MURRY
(Nik voice)
More like an action figure.

Valerie LAUGHS way too loud. Looks at her goose bumps. Then she steps inside the dressing room.

VALERIE
This is thrilling, Murry. Or should
I call you Nik?

She closes the curtain behind her.

EXT. VILLAGE HOUSE - NIGHT

Murry looks in a window's reflection. Sees his smooth face. Well-fitted clothes. Then sniffs himself. He can do this.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - NIGHT

Murry swipes his keyfab, marches right inside...until:

RECEPTIONIST (O.S.)

Mr. Lamb?

Murry stops. Shit.

RECEPTIONIST (CONT'D)

Just be careful. The floor is wet.

FIREPLACE

Murry "reads a book". But really, he watches people around him. How they sit. How they drink. How they laugh.

Inside his "book", YouTube plays on his phone: "BEAR MARKET MAVEN: Buying the Dip". Earbud in ear.

WENDY (O.S.)

Murry?

The petite but powerful WENDY (his age) appears on his flank. He's happy to see her. Just...um...speechless.

WENDY (CONT'D)

It's Wendy Win. Rutgers? I thought
I saw you here the other day.

BAR

Murry drinks club soda. Wendy pounds a cocktail and bar nuts.

WENDY (CONT'D)

So what are you up to these days?
Davis said you were a doorman?

MURRY

That's so funny. Davis is great.

WENDY

So you're *not* a doorman?

Murry shakes his head. Wendy smirks. Murry squints: what?

WENDY (CONT'D)

Nothing. It's just, you don't care
that Davis made that up about you?

MURRY

I control what I can control.

WENDY

You really haven't changed.
(laughing to self)

WENDY (CONT'D)

I was actually just thinking about what you said after that whole probiotic energy drink thing.

(Murry voice)

"You can never really know if a choice is right or wrong. All you can do is make it right."

(catching herself)

Sorry, I shouldn't bring that up.

MURRY

It's fine. It's cool. The best entrepreneurs don't finish college. And I channeled those lessons into my new business model.

WENDY

Cool. What's the business?

What. He's not ready for that. He flushes red.

WENDY

Relax. If it's good enough for us to steal, you're doing great.

MURRY

Us?

WENDY

Yeah. I'm at Peerson Danowitz?

Murry CHOKES on his club soda.

WENDY (CONT'D)

The VC firm.

MURRY

I know. Yeah. That's cool. Um. But I shouldn't talk about it. It's um, it's in...*stealth mode*.

WENDY

Murry. I'm the stealthiest. Just take me up to 30 thousand feet.

MURRY

I've never flown that high.

She LAUGHS loud. Touches his arm. Giving him confidence.

MURRY

Fine. It's simple: *non-fungible fragrances*. Custom crafted scents, tokenized and tradable on-chain.

MURRY (CONT'D)

(off silence)

I've been working on the phrasing.
Is that high-level enough?

WENDY

Right at cruising altitude.

He's not sure if she's serious. She rises.

WENDY (CONT'D)

And it's interesting.

He sinks. He knows what this means.

WENDY

Really. I just have to get to
dinner. But let's connect. I have
your number right?

She checks her phone. Got it. Then gives him a quick hug.

WENDY

Good to see you, Murry. And good to
see you're still...Murry.

On her way out, she texts "got something interesting".

SERA (PRE-LAP)

Murry.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Sera leaves a voicemail as she folds laundry.

SERA (CONT'D)

I just want to know where are. If
you're in trouble - even if it's
money, I will help. And I won't be
judgy. I promise. Please call me.

Meanwhile, her Toddler watches a nature show on TV.

NATURE SHOW (TV)

--by changing color, the cuttlefish
can hide in plain sight, conserving
energy for its singular task:
protecting its young from danger.

Her Husband pokes his head in from the hall.

HUSBAND

Hey. Are you busy?

No. She's done folding. Just one more item: Murry's t-shirt.

SERA

Yes.

(loading a lie)

I'm meeting the girls. In the city.

CUTTLEFISH swim on TV.

MATCH CUT TO:

CUTTLEFISH

on Nik's TV. Snacks sprawled out in front of it.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - DAY

Murry, meanwhile, takes a bubble bath. He looks at a reflective ceiling. Sees his shaven face. Makes a bubble beard...then quickly wipes it off.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)

What makes us us?

LIVING ROOM - LATER

Murry practices his pitch for Valerie.

MURRY (CONT'D)

As luxury goods become accessible,
consumers are desperately seeking
new ways to stand out--

RINGGG RINGGG

VALERIE

Is that you?

He shakes his head. RINGING stops. He resets.

MURRY

But identity isn't static--

RINGING again. Valerie looks at the wall, it's her phone.

VALERIE

I'll call them back. Go ahead.

But before he can start again...KNOCK KNOCK

Snacks BARKS at the door. Murry and Valerie exchange a look.

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
Nikos! We know you're in there.

Murry races to the peephole. Oh no.

He turns back to Valerie. But she's already gone.

PENTHOUSE FLOOR

KNOCK KNOCK KNOCK as Cynthia yells:

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
Open up!

Behind her: the rest of the CO-OP BOARD. Except one...

VALERIE (O.S.)
What's going on here?

...until Valerie pokes her head out from Penthouse A.

CYNTHIA
There you are. I've been calling
you. Emergency Board meeting. Now.
(whispering)
We're ambushing him, Valerie.
(slipping key into door)
This is an ambush!

PENTHOUSE B

LOCK JIGGLES. Murry desperately calls Nik. Not answering.

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
This is the Co-Op Board. We have
commandeered the master key under
Article 4 of our charter,
granting access in cases of
emergency or suspected criminality.

Cynthia opens the door and marches right in...

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
And you, Nikos, have been acting
like a god damn criminal.

...trailed by RHONDA (80) and LARRY (90s, motorized chair)...

...and Valerie who mouths to Murry: "I had no idea".

VALERIE
We can handle this like adults.

CYNTHIA
He's the one avoiding us.

Valerie secretly mimes a cough.

MURRY
(COUGH)
I've just been really sick--

CYNTHIA
No rescheduling now. Rhonda already
bought bagels.

RHONDA
I only have two everything.

Rhonda holds up a bag to Murry but Cynthia snatches it away.

CYNTHIA
He gets nothing.

VALERIE
We need plates.

KITCHEN

Murry gets Nik's voicemail again as Valerie scurries in.

VALERIE
I had no idea this was happening.

MURRY
What is happening?

VALERIE
Some on the Board believe Nikki is
mismanaging our money.

MURRY
Wait. You're his clients too?

VALERIE
Of course. He runs the Co-Op fund.
But recently, he's been...evasive.

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
What's taking so long?

VALERIE
He's making coffee!

MURRY
You have to get them to leave.

VALERIE

I can't. That crusty spider has every right to invoke Article 4. But it's not like she knows anything about finance. She just wants to make Nik dance...
(grabbing hips, swaying)
...so let's dance for her, Nikki.

LIVING ROOM

Valerie sets down the plates as the Board selects bagels.

CYNTHIA

No spreads?

RHONDA

There's cream cheese.

CYNTHIA

That's basically a condiment. This is a luxury building.

VALERIE

You don't eat it anyway.

CYNTHIA

I want the option. And don't you think Larry deserves a little lox?

They turn to the legendary Larry in his motorized wheelchair. But he doesn't say a word. He never does.

VALERIE

Larry likes whitefish, but the doctors worry he'll choke. You'd know that if you ever talked to him.

RHONDA

Can I use the bathroom first?

Murry hustles in with a carafe full of coffee. And we're off.

CYNTHIA

Just take the damn minutes, Rhonda.
(BANGING cane on floor)
Calling this emergency meeting to order. Present with the Board today is Nikos Lamb of Penthouse B and manager of the Cooperative Investment Fund. I'll begin by formally requesting our now past due quarterly statements.

Murry gulps. He's in too deep. But--

VALERIE

Can I just ask a question first?

He quietly exhales. Thank god.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

What the hell are you doing Nikos?

He flinches. Valerie charges full steam ahead.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

We trusted you. We urged everyone
in the building to give you their
hard-earned savings. And now you
think you can--

(to Rhonda)

What did your niece call it?

RHONDA

Ghosting.

VALERIE

You think you can just *ghost* us?

(before he can respond)

I don't want to hear your excuses.
You have two weeks to get us those
statements. Or we're going to have
to get our attorneys involved. Do
you understand?

Murry nods very solemnly.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

Then I'm satisfied. Larry's tired.

(rising)

We'll reconvene when we have the
facts. In two weeks.

Larry doesn't say a word. Cynthia sneers at Murry.

CYNTHIA

You really have nothing to say for
yourself?

VALERIE

He's sick, Cynthia.

CYNTHIA

Why won't you let him speak?

MURRY

There's not much to say.

Valerie shakes her head. Stop speaking! But it's too late.

CYNTHIA
What happened to your voice?

MURRY
I'm sick, *Cynthia*.

The sharp tone cuts through the room. Valerie nods: *proceed*.

MURRY (CONT'D)
But the portfolio is healthy.
(careful, breathing)
I'll walk you through all the
details in two weeks. For now, I
just need you to be patient.

CYNTHIA
You know I'm not a patient woman.

MURRY
And that will cost you.

CYNTHIA
Excuse me?

Valerie shoots him a look: *what are you doing?* He resets.

MURRY
I mean the market rewards patience.
Fear is what's expensive. Remember:
you're being paid to tolerate risk.

Valerie smirks. But carefully gestures to wrap it up.

MURRY (CONT'D)
And I'm being paid to be aggressive
and opportunistic. If you can't
tolerate that, take the points on
your savings account.
(rising)
And take the bagels with you. I
don't eat white bread.

Valerie secretly smiles. Cynthia openly scowls.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - DAY

Murry exhales outside as Valerie skips over from Penthouse A.

VALERIE
You did it! That was so exciting.
Look at my arm!

Valerie displays proud goosebumps. Sees his dour face.

VALERIE

What's wrong?

MURRY

You hate me.

VALERIE

It's not personal.

(touching his face)

It's just Manhattan. It'd be suspicious if I wasn't harsh with Nik in front of them.

MURRY

Because he's a criminal.

VALERIE

Criminal? *Please.* That sounds so pedestrian. Nik is more...in the middle. And I'll tell you a secret: most of the people up here are dabbling in *some sort of gray area.*

Valerie reviews adjacent penthouses around the deck.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

Really. I spent 35 years as an auditor before I sold the firm. I know every trick in the book.

MURRY

I didn't know you had a company.

VALERIE

Of course. I climbed my way up here with my own bare hands.

MURRY

You were never married?

VALERIE

I had a husband.

(looking down on street)

But he was of limited utility.

She turns back to Murry. Adjusts his collar lovingly.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

You, though, have certainly proven your worth. Nik is lucky to have you, whether he deserves it or not. He'll be happy when he gets home.

MURRY

But do you think helping cover for him makes me a bad person?

VALERIE

Bad person? Darling, *he's* the bad person. You're a better Nik than Nik ever was. If anyone's earned a life like this, it's you.

PRE-LAP: RINGGG RINGGG

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

Murry, scrambles in, shirt off. Answers Nik's call.

MURRY

Nik. Hey. Listen. I was just going to call you--

NIK (PHONE)

I know. Rhonda emailed the minutes. Did you enjoy the Board meeting?

MURRY

I was ambushed.

NIK (PHONE)

You could have run away.

Murry sinks. He knows.

NIK (PHONE) (CONT'D)

But you stepped up. You saved the day. Where did you learn so much about asset management?

MURRY

YouTube.

NIK (PHONE)

Impressive. And much appreciated. You just bought me two more weeks to get everything sorted out.

MURRY

Wait. So you're not coming back?

NIK (PHONE)

Do you want me to?

Murry looks around the penthouse. Then at Snacks. He sits slowly on the sofa. No.

NIK (PHONE)

Listen. I'm sorry about all this.
I'm not the man they think I am. My
business is just...*complicated*. But
this'll blow over. I promise.
Still, if you need me to come home--

MURRY

No. It's okay. I can stay.

NIK (PHONE)

Really? You're sure?

MURRY

Yes. Anything else I can help with?

NIK (PHONE)

Yes, actually. Do you know a place
downtown called the Village House?

Oh no. Did they call him about Murry going there?

NIK (PHONE)(CONT'D)

Well I prepay a monthly tab and it
expires tomorrow. No rollovers. Why
don't you head down there and make
sure it doesn't go to waste?

MURRY

I think I can handle that.

EXT. STREET - SAME

Nik talks to Murry on a bench, framed by Manhattan towers.
His new beard is growing nicely.

NIK (CONT'D)

I know you can, Nikki.

A CAR DRIVES BY

Inside, Sera peeks at the man. Can't see his face.

She pulls down the street. Parks. Behind her in the rearview:
The Pyramid.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - NIGHT

Looking fine, Murry steps off the elevator and hears:

SERA (O.S.)
Murry. He's my brother.

OH NO. He turns around and presses DOWN. Hurry!

SERA (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Have you seen him?

FRONT DESK

Meanwhile, Barry deals with Sera.

BARRY
I thought he was on vacation. Is he
in trouble or something?

SERA
Honestly, I don't know.
(nodding to guest divan)
Mind if I wait here for a bit?

BARRY
Yes.

PRE-LAP: DING!

BASEMENT

Murry gets off on the basement floor. Heads out back exit.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera jumps in her car. Huffs, annoyed.

Phone RINGS. It's Murry! She answers on speakerphone.

MURRY (PHONE)
Sera. You're going to get me in
trouble at work.

SERA
So you answer Barney's calls and
not mine?

MURRY (PHONE)
Barry is my manager. Technically.
And I'm trying *not* to use my phone
so I can fully focus.

SERA
Where?

INT./EXT. TAXI - SAME

Murry hops in a cab as he talks to Sera. Frustrated.

SERA (PHONE) (CONT'D)
Why won't you just tell me whose
place you've been staying at?

MURRY
Is it so unbelievable that I got my
own place?

SERA (PHONE)
Yes. You don't have any money.

Insulted, Murry puffs up as car drives. *Should he lie?*

MURRY
I actually have a new investor.

He's pleased with the way it sounds.

SERA (PHONE)
In the *body spray*?

A FIRETRUCK WAILS as it passes by the cab.

MURRY
It's custom fragrance!

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera hears the FIRETRUCK WAILING on speakerphone before he hangs up. Hm. He must be close. She thinks.

Texts Husband: "going to be late tonight." Looks at it.
Deletes the period. Sends.

In the rearview mirror: Barry opens the door for a resident.

But Sera ignores it.

She's waiting for Murry.

RECEPTIONIST (PRE-LAP)
Welcome back, Mr. Lamb.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - NIGHT

A receptionist checks Nik's member ID on a screen.

Murry strolls inside. Pleased with himself.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

BARK BARK BARK

Snacks sniffs TWO SHOES at the door.

But they march straight past him to the bedroom...

...leaving Snacks sniffing and confused for a few beats...

...until they return with a stuffed duffel bag and walk right back out the door. Snacks whimpers, unpet.

PRE-LAP: DING!

BASEMENT - A MINUTE LATER

Two shoes step off the elevator, head through the basement - duffel bag dangling - out the back exit.

EXT. PYRAMID - BACK ALLEY - NIGHT

Standing in the two shoes: a man buttons a doorman uniform.

He checks his reflection in a window:

It's Nik. Real Nik. But Bearded. Looking just like old Murry.

INT. VILLAGE HOUSE - RESTAURANT - SAME

Real Murry enjoys gnocchi and sparkling water.

PRE-LAP: RINGGGGGG

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera answers her Husband's call on speakerphone.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
Where are you?

SERA
I told you. I'm with the girls.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
For six hours? You don't even like them. Are you following him?

SERA
What. I'm not following him.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
Then where are you?

She quickly thinks of a story.

SERA
I'm working on a story.
(off a quiet gasp)
Don't be so surprised.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
No I'm just--

SERA
Don't say proud. What is it?

HUSBAND (PHONE)
Oh. Nothing. She's looking for her
police costume. Or just the badge?

Sera looks under the seat and finds a TOY POLICE BADGE.

SERA
I thought she was the little
mermaid.

HUSBAND (PHONE)
She's an undersea detective. Just -
do you have it or not?

She sees a BEARDED MAN IN A DOORMAN UNIFORM walk inside.

She hangs up. Of course, she thinks it's:

JUJU (PRE-LAP)
Murry?

And she sits back to wait. *He has to come out eventually.*

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - SAME

Juju, now on his shift, opens for the bearded doorman: Nik.

JUJU (CONT'D)
What are you doing here? I thought
you were still on vacation.

NIK
I just need my phone charger.

Nik races straight past him. Weird. But Juju shrugs it off.

PRE-LAP: DING DONG!

21C

Cynthia peers through the peephole.

CYNTHIA
Murphy? Is everything okay?

The door SWINGS OPEN--

--right into her forehead.

Knocking her to the floor.

Nik steps over her as she bleeds and writhes in pain.

He finds a laptop. Plugs in a thumbdrive. Then gets to work.

As Cynthia moans on the floor, he copies excel files to the drive. Finishes quickly. She whimpers:

CYNTHIA
What are you doing?

NIK
Quitting.

He SNAPS the laptop closed. Yanks out the thumbdrive.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera sees the back of a well-dressed resident walking inside. But doesn't even register.

JUJU (PRE-LAP)
There he is, *Nikki Nik*.

She's still waiting for Murry to come out.

INT. PYRAMID - LOBBY - SAME

But Murry's coming in, as Juju holds the door.

PENTHOUSE B

BARK BARK BARK as Murry returns.

He gives Snacks the love Nik just withheld.

But the dog keeps BARKING toward the deck.

Murry turns to look.

Lit from inside, the glass door is reflective. In it he sees:
a bearded man in a doorman uniform.

He quickly shakes it off. It's just his imagination. But it's hard not to see. *He's going back down soon.*

BEDROOM

Murry folds a sweater in the closet.

But then realizes: his doorman uniform is gone.

BARK BARK

LIVING ROOM

Murry races back in, expecting to see someone.

MURRY
Is someone there?

But no one's there. Just Snacks BARKING toward the glass door to the deck. Like before, it's fully reflective.

So he kills the lights - revealing, on the other side:

Nik.

Bearded.

In the doorman uniform.

Murry SCREAMS. Nik rushes inside. Finger to lips.

NIK
Shh. This isn't what it looks like.

Murry sees BLOOD on Nik's shoes.

MURRY
What did you do?

Then he notices Nik's beard. And the nametag on the uniform.

MURRY (CONT'D)
What did I do?

He steps back in fear.

CREAK.

Snacks BARKS toward the deck again. Someone's there.

NIK

Murry.

(whispering)

Do we have a guest?

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Valerie spies in the Penthouse B window. But the light's off.

Can't see inside...just a reflection of towers. Until:

NIK (O.S.)

You should have stayed in the
Hamptons.

a doorman uniform appears behind her.

INT. PYRAMID HOUSE - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Murry hears a SCREAM from outside.

He SWINGS open the door and sees:

Nik grappling with Valerie by the edge of the deck.

VALERIE

Help!

Murry charges outside...

SERA (PRE-LAP)

Maybe it was Murry.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - NIGHT

Two skeptical eyes monitor the Pyramid through the mirrors.

Sera squeezes a juicebox in her mouth, SPLATTERING RED on her sweatpants. She checks the backseat for wetwipes...

SERA (PRE-LAP)

But that makes no sense to me.

Meanwhile, in the:

REARVIEW MIRROR

A BODY DROPS from the top of the Pyramid and--

THREE: **DROP**

SPLATS onto the street.

INT. NYPD - INTERVIEW ROOM - TWO HOURS LATER

REVEAL two DETECTIVES interviewing Sera.

SERA (CONT'D)
It's not who he is.

The Detectives exchange an incredulous look. But she's serious. She usually is.

SERA
I want to see him now.

PRE-LAP: RINGGGGGG RINGGGGGG

FRONT DESK

RINGING ends on Husband's phone. He looks up at the DESK COP.

HUSBAND
She's not answering.

DESK COP
And this is the mother?

HUSBAND
Sister.

DESK COP
Oh. *Her*. She was at the scene.

He flinches. What. The Cop checks the monitor.

DESK COP
She's heading in to see him now.

HALLWAY

Detective 2 walks Sera through the precinct...

HUSBAND (V.O.)
What happened?

...along the holding cells...

DESK COP (V.O.)
We were hoping you could tell us.

...until they reach a heavy door into the:

MORGUE

Sera stands in the cold, steel room. Lights humming.

SERA
That's him.

On the gurney below her:

A blood-stained doorman uniform. Filled with the mush of a man who fell 300 feet. Face obliterated by asphalt.

DETECTIVE 2 (O.S.)
We can still do quick DNA swab--

SERA
No. That's my brother. Murat Oğan.

She looks down. At the nametag.

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)
Murry?

INT. PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Murry stares at his face in the mirror. His hand shaking.

VALERIE (PRE-LAP) (CONT'D)
Our Murry?

EXT. PYRAMID - NIGHT

An NYPD SERGEANT briefs sobbing Valerie by the door. Street is dark. Quiet except for chatter and cleanup.

SERGEANT
The detectives will come by in the morning. I can't imagine--

VALERIE
No. You can't.

She looks at the police tape outside her home. The spot. Then starts sobbing. He puts a hand on her shoulder. She exhales.

VALERIE
Well, I guess you can't keep the past buried forever.

SERGEANT
Buried? What was buried?

She gives him a look. Confused he doesn't already know.

VALERIE
Him.

MURRY (PRE-LAP)
You told them about that?

INT. PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Murry cracks the bathroom door open to talk to Valerie.

VALERIE
It was in your immigration file. We saw it in the background check. But this is good - well, *not good*, but you get it. People hear *trauma* and *mental illness* and stop thinking. This explains what happened.

Murry looks in the mirror. What did happen?

SERA (PRE-LAP)
He wouldn't kill himself.

INT. NYPD - NIGHT

Sera argues with a Detective 1 outside the morgue.

DETECTIVE 1
You told us you were following him because you were worried.

SERA
Not about this.

DETECTIVE 1
Sera. People suffer in silence.

She hates that answer. But before she can blow--

HUSBAND (O.S.)
Sera! Are you okay?

Husband charges down the hall. Wraps her in a big hug.

SERA
Yeah. I just got here.

Husband knows she's lying, but keeps it to himself.

HUSBAND

So. What happens now?

INT. PENTHOUSE B - BATHROOM - NIGHT

Valerie steps into the bathroom. Closes the door.

VALERIE

Listen to me. You saved my life.
And I will do anything to protect
yours. Whichever you choose. But
you need to choose. Right now. If
Murry's not dead, then he killed
Nik. Do you understand?

Murry turns to the mirror. Stiff. Valerie recalibrates.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

What am I thinking? This is insane.
Call the police. Tell them you've
been in shock. That's why you
didn't report it right away. Then
tell them the truth. Yes, you were
impersonating him. But he was
manipulating you! From the start.
The walls were closing on him - *we*
were closing in. And you were his
way out. He knew you'd do anything
to get up here. And he pulled your
strings like a puppet--

She opens the door and he steps forward but--

He pushes it closed.

MURRY

I'm not a puppet.

VALERIE

But Murry--

MURRY

Murry is dead.

Murry looks in the mirror. Breathes. Then opens the door.

MURRY (CONT'D)

We should get rid of his stuff.

PRE-LAP: BARK BARK BARK

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)
Is that everything?

CLOSET - A LITTLE LATER

Murry covers his box of fragrances with a blanket.

VALERIE (O.S.)(CONT'D)
What about this?

Valerie appears behind him. But doesn't see the box. Just pulls his phone from his back pocket. She'll take care of it.

FIREPLACE ROARS

The doorman cap and Murry's wallet melt in the embers.

Snacks SNIFFS at Murry's feet.

Flames illuminating his perfectly shaven face.

PRE-LAP: KNOCK KNOCK, BARK BARK

DETECTIVE 1 (PRE-LAP)
Mr. Lamb?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - MORNING

Snacks races to four new feet at the door.

DETECTIVE 1 (O.S.)(CONT'D)
Is now a good time? We're speaking
with all the tenants.

Murry welcomes in the Detectives with a graceful smile.

MURRY
And you're starting at the top.

Then catches his reflection in the mirror: a moment of fear.
He adjusts his facial expression. Then closes the door.

MURRY (CONT'D)
Coffee?

DETECTIVE 2
Do you have any tea?

Murry halts. He actually doesn't know.

KITCHEN

Murry catches his breath. And recites his old affirmation:
"Be the person you want to be."

DETECTIVE 2 (O.S.)
 What was that?

MURRY
 Oh. Just looking for the tea!

LIVING ROOM

Murry returns with one coffee but no tea.

DETECTIVE 1
 Let's just get started. So, Murry--

MURRY
 Yes?

They set down a print-out of Murry's drivers license photo.

DETECTIVE 2
 Did you see him last night?

As Murry sits, he studies the wild hair and a bushy beard.

Looks nothing like the clean shaven man sitting here. Murry relaxes, knowing there's no resemblance for them to clock.

MURRY
 I thought he was on vacation.

DETECTIVE 2
 Right. But the cameras show him
 getting off on this floor.
 (off Murry's gulp)
 Presumably to access stairs to the
 roof. Had he been acting strange?

MURRY
 Definitely. Depressed, even.

DETECTIVE 1
 We heard he was the chipper type.

MURRY
 Well he was. That's what was so
 strange about it. Him being *down*.

DETECTIVE 2
 So you knew him well.

MURRY

No. Not really. He walked my dog
and gave him insulin sometimes.

DETECTIVE 1

But he's otherwise been...*normal*?

MURRY

(scratching Snacks's butt)
Basically. Though he'll eat
absolutely anything off the ground.

DETECTIVE 2

Not the dog. *Murry*. Did you know
him well or not?

Murry shakes his head too fast.

DETECTIVE 2

But you were close enough that you
noticed a change in behavior.

Murry considers his angles. Hiding his panic.

MURRY

Was I supposed to?

He sees his reflection. Nik. Squares his shoulders.

MURRY

The truth is: Murry wasn't a
neighbor. He wasn't a friend. He
was staff. *He* pays attention to *us*.
Not the other way around.

The Detectives exchange a look. Then back at him.

DETECTIVE 2

So you *didn't* notice anything?

Murry shakes his head, firmly. Confident. Detective 2 holds
eye contact for another beat...

DETECTIVE 1

Thanks for your time, Mr. Lamb.

...then closes his notebook. They rise.

As Murry exhales, Detective 2 stops at the door.

DETECTIVE 2

What about the money?

They both turn.

DETECTIVE 1

Right. Did you ever give Murry any money? Besides tips.

MURRY

Why else would I give Murry money?

DETECTIVE 1

You are an investor. Correct?

(off his nod)

Well apparently, Murry claimed to have an investor. In his business.

MURRY

You mean the *cologne*?

He looks at closet where he hid the BOX OF FRAGRANCE. Shit. They follow his eyes until HE LAUGHS, drawing them back.

MURRY

Sorry. I shouldn't laugh. Yes. Murry told me about his...*idea*. But that's not the kind of investment I do. This isn't Shark Tank.

(quiet gulp)

He hasn't been going around telling people I *invested* in him. Has he?

HUSBAND (PRE-LAP)

Investor? When did he say that?

INT./EXT. HUSBAND'S CAR - SAME

Sera rides shotgun as Husband drives.

SERA

Oh. Um. Just before he left.

He feels a lie. But lets it go. He has bigger fish. A beat.

HUSBAND

Sera. Why didn't you tell the detectives about Turkey?

She thinks for a moment. Then murmurs:

SERA

Because that's all they'd need to know. Just drop me at my car.

HUSBAND

Fine. Where is it?

She prepares a lie. But they hit a light. She opens the door.

SERA
I can walk from here.

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)
You should be in the hospital.

INT. PYRAMID - 21C - DAY

Valerie finds Cynthia, head-bandaged, in bed. DR. FLICKER tends to her. Larry and Rhonda there in support.

DR. FLICKER
It's just a bump on the head.
She'll be fine with some rest.

VALERIE
Ross. You're a gastroenterologist.

RHONDA
I actually just read about the
brain-gut connection in the Times--

VALERIE
Then how about fetching some food?

Valerie makes harsh eye contact: leave. They comply.

CYNTHIA
I don't need any food.

Cynthia leans forward. Valerie pushes her right back down.

VALERIE
You need rest. And I need answers.
(careful seat)
I'm concerned, Cynthia. An attack
on you is an attack on all of us.

CYNTHIA
They're still scooping him off the
street. He got what he deserved.

VALERIE
He didn't get anything else?

CYNTHIA
I don't know. I was on the floor.
(thinking, cautious)
But I think he was on my computer.

Valerie heads into the other room...

CYNTHIA

Hey. You can't just unplug that.

...returns with a big chunky laptop. Boots it up. Valerie browses RECENT APPS. Finds: FIN-X.

VALERIE

Why do you have FIN-X installed?

CYNTHIA

It's an accounting program.

VALERIE

I have a CFA, Cynthia. I know what FIN-X is. Why is on your laptop?

CYNTHIA

I'm Treasurer of the Co-Op Board.

VALERIE

That is a *ceremonial* position.

CYNTHIA

Not according to the National Board of Co-Op Board Treasurers.

Valerie squints. *What's that?* Cynthia beams with proud.

CYNTHIA

That's right. I was recruited by a charming local representative. He's the one who gave me that software.

(bragging)

For free. He even helped me link our accounts over the phone.

Valerie closes the laptop. Rubs temples. Steps to Cynthia.

VALERIE

You brainless invertebrate.

Valerie DROPS the heavy laptop on Cynthia's torso. OW!

VALERIE (CONT'D)

Don't you realize who that was?

DETECTIVE 1 (PRE-LAP)

Nikos Lamb. He goes by Nik.

INT./EXT. SQUAD CAR - DAY

Outside the Pyramid, the Detectives talk to Sera on speaker.

DETECTIVE 1 (CONT'D)
There are other investors and
finance types in the building, but
they're all retirees.

SERA (PHONE)
And this guy really knew Murry?

DETECTIVE 2
They all knew Murry.

DETECTIVE 1
(holding him back, relax)
Yes, Murry helped him with his dog.
But there's no indication of a
business relationship. We checked
the bank records too.

SERA (PHONE)
I still want to talk to him.

DETECTIVE 2
(muting)
Is she fucking serious? We've
already indulged her enough.

SERA (PHONE)
I'm going over there.

DETECTIVE 1
(quickly unmuting)
Absolutely not. This is an active
investigation. Stay away from the
Pyramid and do not harass any
residents. We won't warn you again.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - SAME

Sera hides as she watches the Detectives drive off.

CALL ENDS. Her stereo automatically returns to a podcast:

PODCAST (STEREO)
--most of opportunities. But most
people quit before they even try.
And you're not most people.

Sera looks out the window: where Murry fell.

INT. BANK - VAULT - DAY

PODCAST continues in Murry's ear as he heads into the vault.

PODCAST (EARBUD) (CONT'D)
 Don't just stare at the choice you
 made. Find the next one.

Murry opens a safe deposit box. Finds the Co-Op ownership agreement...then Nik's birth certificate.

EXT. PYRAMID - DAY

Sera steps out of her car. Looks around the yellow police tape, where he fell.

Nearby: a storm drain. She spots a small plastic rectangle tucked under the lip.

It's a thumbdrive. Sera looks at it. Then up at the roof.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - DAY

Sera jumps back in her car. Inspects the thumbdrive.

It's stamped with initials: NCL. Hm.

She grabs her phone, about to call the Detectives. Until--

KNOCK KNOCK at her window.

VALERIE (O.S.)
 Can I help you?

Sera shakes her head without lowering the window for Valerie.

VALERIE
 I'm sorry. But I saw you poking
 around. This is a crime scene.

Sera thinks. Grabs her daughter's toy police badge. Holds it up against the window. Speaks loudly, confident:

SERA
 I'm aware. Are you a resident?

VALERIE
 I am Co-President of the Board.

Hm. Sera lowers the window.

SERA
 So you know everyone here?

WENDY (PRE-LAP)
Murry?

INT. BANK - DAY

Wendy spots Murry walking out past the ATMs.

MURRY

Wendy. What are you doing here?

WENDY

This is where I kickbox.

MURRY

I didn't know you kickboxed.

WENDY

(are you dumb?)

I'm using the ATM. Are you okay?
I've been calling.

MURRY

Oh sorry. I lost my phone.

WENDY

Alright...*well*, I soft-pitched your
idea to the deal team. And buddy,
they are Capital-I *Intrigued*.

MURRY

Really? I barely told you anything.

WENDY

Exactly. Less is more with these
guys. They hear the word stealth
and immediately cream their chinos.

Ew.

WENDY

Sorry, that's the culture. Any
chance you have time to talk now?

Someone KNOCKS into him. His documents scatter on the floor.

Wendy drops to help. Tries not to look...then looks...sees a
Cooperative Equity Agreement. Um.

WENDY

Dude. You own a place at the Pyramid?
That condo down the block?

MURRY

It's technically a co-op.

WENDY

And technically your family's...?

MURRY

It's mine. And it was great seeing you. But my dog needs to go out--

WENDY

Oh my god. Can I meet him?

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)

Nik?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE A - DAY

Valerie serves Sera tea and joins her on the sofa.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

What does he have to do with Murry?

Sera tries to remember what detectives sound like on TV.

SERA

Is it possible that Nik lent him money, or something of that nature?

VALERIE

(pretending to consider)

No. Nik wouldn't give Murry money.

SERA

Why?

VALERIE

Because Nik isn't the kind of investor who gives anyone anything. He's the kind that takes it.

(sipping tea)

The man is a money manager.

SERA

You seem to know a lot about him.

VALERIE

He manages our money. The whole co-op investment fund. Not to mention, *Detective*, he lives next door.

BARK BARK from next door. Sera looks at the wall.

SERA

Is that him?

VALERIE

I don't think so. That poor dog is blind. He tends to bark at ghosts.

Sera sees a small bathroom alongside the same wall.

SERA
Could I use your bathroom?

PENTHOUSE B

BARK BARK BARK as Murry leads Wendy inside and meets Snacks.

MURRY
Let me get the samples.

BATHROOM

Sera listens through the wall. Hears muffled speaking. Hm. Then she opens the door...but...it's locked. She knocks.

SERA
Hello? Ms. Muller?

LIVING ROOM

Valerie holds a chair to the door. Fake BADGE in her hand.

VALERIE
Hello, *Officer Octopus*. Who are you
and what are you doing here?

SERA (O.S.)
Let me out and I'll explain.

VALERIE
Explain it to the real police!

SERA (O.S.)
I'm Murry's sister!

Valerie releases the chair. Steps back. Sera opens the door.

SERA
I think Nik had something to do
with my brother's death.

VALERIE
So what are you doing in my powder
room!? Tell the detectives!

SERA
I did. They think I'm crazy.

Valerie snorts: *I wonder why.*

SERA (CONT'D)
I'm not crazy. Look.

She shows her the thumbdrive. It says NCL.

WENDY (PRE-LAP)
Nikos Casavetes Lamb.

PENTHOUSE B

Murry brings back the box. But doesn't see Wendy.

MURRY
Did you say something?

WENDY (O.S.)
Murry. Who is Nikos?

He turns and finds her reading Snacks's tag.

MURRY
Oh, *Nik*.
(fuck)
Yeah, he lived here. I sort of um
inherited his dog when I took over
the apartment.

WENDY
So why do you have his license?

Wendy drops his wallet. Her voice sharpens, deepens.

WENDY (CONT'D)
What the fuck is going on? Did you
fake this identity to defraud
investors or something? Were you
going to fuck me? Were you going to
fuck...*Pearson*?

MURRY
They have nothing to do with this.

WENDY
I told you: the deal team is
interested. When you didn't answer
my calls, they freaked out.

MURRY
Wait. So you followed me? They
think my idea is that good?

WENDY
They think your idea is dogshit.

Wendy simmers. Murry's never seen the wolf in her before.

WENDY (CONT'D)

Exactly the type of dogshit morons
like you spend money on. They
wanted me to buy you out and
license the concept in less
regulated markets.

(panic meeting anger)

Now, the partners are gonna find
out I got hustled by some
delusional con man who sleeps in
his sister's basement!

MURRY

I sleep here! And Nik is not a fake
identity or anything. He's real.

WENDY

Then where is he?

Murry has no response. Wendy's starting to get freaked out.

WENDY

Where is he, Murry?

MURRY

He's um traveling. Indefinitely.

Snacks BARKS. Wendy sees on the mantle: a photo of "Nik" in
front of a mountain. Murry's face...obviously photoshopped.

WENDY

Oh my god. What did you do?

She backs to the door.

MURRY

Nothing.

WENDY

Then where is he, Murry?

Murry can't spit out a response. Wendy grabs the door handle--

Murry grabs her hand.

MURRY

He's here.

(hands off and up)

He's me.

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)

That's us.

PENTHOUSE A

Next door, the THUMBDRIVE is plugged into Valerie's computer.
On screen: financial documents. Accounts like 12E, 21C, etc.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

That's the Co-Op Fund. Everyone in
the building makes monthly deposits.
And Nik invests it for us.

SERA

And it's all legitimate?

VALERIE

I don't know much about finance.

SERA

Well if it's evidence of a crime...
...and Murry got ahold of it...

Valerie processes the implications. Big sympathetic breath.

VALERIE

Darling. Deep down, you must know:
it wasn't Nik who killed Murry.

(gently)

Murry killed Murry.

PENTHOUSE B

Wendy reads the article on her phone in dismay:

WENDY

You're...DEAD?

DEATH OF UPTOWN DOORMAN RULED A SUICIDE

MURRY

I didn't have a choice.

WENDY

This is insane--

MURRY

Well it's made! All I can do now
is make that choice right.

WENDY

(halting, horrified)

You like this.

MURRY

No, I'm just making the best--

WENDY
No. You want it.

MURRY
Is that so crazy?

Wendy nods. Yes!

SERA (PRE-LAP)
He wasn't crazy.

PENTHOUSE A

Sera shakes her head, tearing up. Valerie speaks more gently.

VALERIE
I know it's hard to accept. But
after all you two went through...

Sera flinches. *What is she talking about?*

VALERIE (CONT'D)
It's okay. The police told me about
the earthquake. *You were just
children.* No one could keep that
type of thing buried forever.

The ground seems to shake beneath Sera...

SERA
No. You don't get it. He was--

VALERIE
I'm talking about you.

...until Valerie CATCHES HER with a hand on the shoulder.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Watching your family disappear. I
can't imagine what I'd do after
such a thing. What *did* you do?

Sera doesn't speak. But Valerie is warm. Easy to confide in.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
Sera. You can talk to me. What did
you do after they disappeared?

SERA
I waited.

VALERIE
Why?

SERA
I could feel he was still there.

VALERIE
Is that how you feel now?

Sera slowly nods. Embarrassed. A tear forming in her eye.

VALERIE
And what does the rational part of
your brain tell you when you think
that thought?
(beat, eye to eye)
Your brother made a choice. And I
get why you still wait for him. But
miracles don't happen twice. And
he's not climbing out this time.

PENTHOUSE B

Murry panics as Wendy grabs her bag.

MURRY
Please don't tell anyone.

WENDY
Tell me why I shouldn't.

MURRY
Because you already told your boss.

She stops. He's right.

MURRY
You really want to be the gullible
associate who got hustled by
some...*delusional con man*?

Wendy stiffens. Steps forward. Eye to eye.

WENDY
Who the fuck do you think you are?

MURRY
Let's not make this personal,
Wendy. We can still do business--

WENDY
Business? What business? Do you
have an LLC? Any IP applications?
Any documentation with a name?

Murry slowly shakes his head. Looks down.

WENDY (CONT'D)

Good.

What. She sniffs around the fragrance box with displeasure.

WENDY

Keep it that way. And keep all your stinky goos. I don't want anything connected to you.

Murry's face folds. What.

WENDY

It's not personal. I was told to bring this concept back to Pearson, ideally without attachments.

(heading for door)

Maybe they'll make me partner and I won't have to work anymore.

He looks at the box. His colognes.

MURRY

But this is my life.

WENDY

That's not what you just told me.

Then looks around the penthouse. Time to make a choice.

MURRY

Go ahead. I have the rest of my life to start new businesses.

WENDY

I don't give a fuck what you do. You're already dead to me.

(with spite)

Nik.

Wendy marches out and slams the door. Snacks whines.

PENTHOUSE A

Sera quickly wipes her eyes. Then unplugs the thumbdrive. Rises. But Valerie grabs her arm.

VALERIE

What will you do with that?

SERA

Figure out what it actually means. Then bring it to the police.

VALERIE
I'll bring it to them. They already
think you're crazy.

Sera simmers. Valerie realizes she's still holding her arm.
Releases her. Sera heads off.

Valerie sighs. Then grabs her phone. Dials 911.

VALERIE
Yes. There's a crazy woman here
impersonating a police officer--

PRE-LAP: DING!

ELEVATOR

Wendy presses DOWN. As the doors close, Sera approaches...

Wendy reaches to hold the door, but--

SERA

stops. SNIFFS. Elevator doors close as she turns her head to:

PENTHOUSE B

where Valerie charges inside from the deck to find Murry.

VALERIE
We have a problem.

MURRY
I took care of it.

Valerie shakes her head. Nods to the door. Murry steps over
and checks the peephole. Sees:

SERA

on the other side. SNIFFING. Listening. Then--

RED/BLUE flashes through the window. She races to the stairs.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - DAY

Murry and Valerie look down at Sera jumping into her car and
driving away...just before police arrive.

MURRY

I'm dead to her and she still can't let me live my life.

VALERIE

Settle down. She has evidence, but she doesn't know what it means.

MURRY

What *does* it mean?

VALERIE

That the Board was right about Nik. About the fund. He was faking trades and pocketing the money. I've seen it a million times. I thought I was smarter than this.

MURRY

What about his other clients?

VALERIE

Nikki. We're your only clients.

Murry falls back onto the sofa. He's going down.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

This is good. We can contain it. We can make a deal with the Board. But only if we deal with those files.

But Murry's sinking. She touches his chest.

VALERIE

Listen. I know none of this is the "right" thing to do. But we can still *make it right*. Right?

MURRY

You listened to the podcast?

VALERIE

Of course. You recommended it. And now I have a recommendation for you. Get those documents. Before your sister buries you with them.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

The THUMBDRIVE is plugged into Sera's laptop.

Next to a printer. Which prints the files by the ream.

HUSBAND (O.S.)
Look who's back from grandma's!

Husband and the Toddler walk in to find:
FINANCIAL DOCUMENTS covering the floor...

HUSBAND
What's uh...what's all this?
...and his wife pacing around them, manic.

SERA
Some type of scheme. I don't know
the shape of it yet.
(inspecting document)
But I know there's a connection.

HUSBAND
To what?

SERA
To him. To Nik--

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - SAME

Murry hides in the bushes, watching the house.

SERA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
--fucking.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - SAME

Husband sighs.

HUSBAND
--Lamb. SERA (CONT'D)
--Lamb.

Sera flinches. *How does he know that?*

HUSBAND (CONT'D)
They just told me everything.

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - SAME

From the bushes, Murry now sees a POLICE CAR in the driveway.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - SAME

Husband opens the door for the Detectives and asks:

HUSBAND

Can we have a few more minutes?

SERA

Sorry am I being arrested?

HUSBAND

No. No one's pressing charges.

DETECTIVE 2

But impersonating an officer is a very serious offense. We warned you, Sera.

SERA

I get it. I'm sorry. Really. But there's something you need to see.

LIVING ROOM

Sera shows the Detectives the files on the floor. Look!

It looks insane. The Detectives aren't sure how to respond.

SERA

This was at the scene. On a USB drive with, guess what, Nik's initials. I'll show you.

She turns for her laptop but--

DETECTIVE 1

Sera. We have no reason to believe that device is in any way connected to your brother or his death.

SERA

But the woman next door--

DETECTIVE 1

Valerie Muller is the one who called us. She said she was scared. That she was telling you what you wanted to hear so you would leave.

SERA

Because she's working with him!

Detectives exchange a look at the Husband, concerned.

DETECTIVE 2

Just give it to her.

Sera squints. *Give her what?*

Detective 1 sighs. Hands her a BOX with her name on it.

DETECTIVE 1
We found this on the roof.

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - SAME

Murry hears the cop car door SLAM. Watches them drive off.
But the others are still inside the house. He needs to wait.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME

Husband finds Sera at the window. Box on the table.

HUSBAND
Do you want me to open it with you?

She doesn't respond.

HUSBAND
Listen. When people are suffering--

SERA
He wasn't suffering.

HUSBAND
I'm talking about you.

INSERT: BODY DROPPING IN THE REARVIEW MIRROR

HUSBAND (CONT'D)
I know you were there. I know you
were following him. And I'm not
mad. I'm just worried.

She turns away from him.

HUSBAND
Sera. Please. This isn't even the
first time you've seen him die.

The earth seems to SHAKE until he GRIPS HER in a hug.

SERA
I want to know the truth.

HUSBAND
No. You don't.

Sera looks at the box from Murry.

HUSBAND

Go be with your daughter. She just
lost her uncle.

Shae exhales. Heads into the:

LIVING ROOM

to look for her Toddler. Finds her on the floor...

...playing with the documents! Making triangles and circles.

SERA

(FREAKING OUT)

What are you doing!?

TODDLER

I'm making shapes mommy.

Sera YANKS her away. Then marches off. Leaving her crying
daughter to her Husband. He sighs.

HUSBAND

Let's get your princess bag.

EXT. SERA'S HOUSE - BACKYARD - NIGHT

It's getting dark. Murry hears the family piling in a car.
Then sees it drive away. Coast is clear.

He creeps toward the house. Cracks a basement window...

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - BATHROOM - SAME

But Sera's still inside. Laying in the tub, shower on.

BASEMENT

Murry searches. Looking for the thumbdrive. Nothing down
here. He heads for the steps, but hears a KNOCK upstairs.

THE FRONT DOOR

is cracked open. Fatma Teyze is KNOCKING. Halva dessert in
hand. She peeks her head inside. Shouts in Turkish.

No one responds. But she hears the shower. Steps inside.

BASEMENT

Murry hears the floor CREAK above him. Shit.

He looks for an escape. But the windows are too high. So he sneaks under the stairs but the--

FLOORBOARD BREAKS and his foot drops through a hole.

He tries to yank it out. But cuts his ankle on jagged wood.

He's stuck.

KITCHEN

Fatma, making coffee, hears the noise downstairs.

BASEMENT

Murry panics as a DOOR OPENS above him.

Fatma steps down...

...but passes over his head. Phew. But--

FATMA

**You shouldn't be here. This isn't
your life anymore.**

She turns and looks him right in the eyes.

KITCHEN

Sera, hearing the commotion, enters in a towel. Listens by the door to the basement. Hears someone coming upstairs...

...and PINS FATMA to the wall.

FATMA

**There you are. I was making coffee
when I heard your brother down
there. Silly boy is stuck again.
He's waiting for you to let him go.**

SERA

Get the fuck out of my house.

Fatma doesn't understand the English. But Sera stares at her until she understands the message. Fatma heads out.

Sera SLAMS the basement door closed.

BASEMENT

Murry, still trapped, exhales at the sound.

But after a few beats, door suddenly OPENS AGAIN--

Sera marches over Murry's head. Looks around. Breathes heavy.

But she feels stupid for even checking.

BENEATH HER FEET: Murry covers his mouth.

SERA (O.S.)

I am crazy.

He holds his breath until...he hears her walk away.

Door closes. He exhales. Then works on his stuck foot.

LIVING ROOM

Above him, Sera walks across the insane mess of documents.

Finally, she opens the box. Inside: perfume. And a note.

She SPRITZES the perfume. She watches the mist drift down...

...then follows it to the floor.

After a bit, she reads Murry's suicide note.

Meanwhile, out the window above her:

MURRY DRAGS his wounded foot across the backyard.

A LITTLE LATER

Sera peels herself off the floor. Cleans up the documents... until noticing the triangle shapes her daughter made. Hm.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

Murry returns.

But no one's barking. And the lights are on.

CYNTHIA (O.S.)

Welcome home...*Murphy*.

Cynthia, head still bandaged, pets Snacks on her lap. Uh oh.

THROUGH THE WINDOW

Valerie secretly spies from the deck. Pulls out her phone.

PRE-LAP: BUZZ BUZZ

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

BUZZING on Sera's phone.

But she's busy. Locked in. Reorganizing files. Arranging by account name and deposit history.

BUZZ BUZZ.

Finally, she answers without looking. Waits.

VALERIE (PHONE)
Sera. Please don't hang up. I'm
sorry I called the police. I was
protecting myself. This is a very
dangerous situation.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - NIGHT

Valerie peers through glass at: Cynthia looming over Murry.

SERA (PHONE)
I know. I can see it now.

INT. SERA'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Sera's on the sofa. Breathless.

VALERIE (PHONE)
See what?

SERA (CONT'D)
The real shape of things.

Looking down at the documents arranged on the floor.

Pharaoh LLC

20B 20D 21C 21F 21G

16C 16F 17A 18B 18E 19A 19D

12A 12C 12E 14B 14C 14E 15A 15D 15F

4H 5D 6A 6C 7B 7F 9A 9F 10B 10D 10E 11C 11D

FOUR: PYRAMID**EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - NIGHT**

Valerie squints.

SERA (PHONE)

It's a ponzi scheme. Your whole Co-Op fund. Everything you've given him to manage...it all goes right to the top. To a single account called Pharaoh LLC.

Valerie winces. She has "Nik" dead-to-rights.

VALERIE

Sera. We need to get that evidence to our attorneys immediately.

(no response, tense)

Sera--

SERA (PHONE)

Not until I figure out what it has to do with Murry.

Valerie's frustrated. Anxious. She thinks.

VALERIE

Then come here. I'll just copy the files. And tell you *everything*. I promise. But you need to hurry up. We're running out of time.

Valerie looks back through the glass: Murry's terrified face.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Cynthia reveals a casserole for Murry, hot on the table.

MURRY

I'm...I'm not hungry.

CYNTHIA

You look worse than I do.

(touching her bandage)

If you don't eat, I'll have to call 911 and get you to the hospital.

She somehow giggles without sound. He slowly inserts a forkful. Hand shaking as he sets it down.

As he chews, he turns to glance at Penthouse A.

CYNTHIA
She can't help you now.

He turns back and she--

JAMS A FORKFUL of casserole in his mouth.

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)
Tonight, you answer to us.

Us? Murry chokes as--

KNOCK KNOCK, BARK BARK as the door opens for:

Larry and Rhonda, who look sweetly at Murry.

RHONDA
Sorry we're late. I picked up some wraps. Are you hungry?

CYNTHIA
I certainly hope so. He has a lot more to swallow.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - NIGHT

Sera drives toward Manhattan's skyline. Phone dying.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

Rhonda pulls out the wraps. Larry is not impressed. On the sofa, Murry leans over to whisper to Cynthia.

MURRY
Do they know about me?

CYNTHIA
(fake whisper)
That you murdered a tenant? Or that you were impersonating him?

She seems to be enjoying this! But she reels it in.

CYNTHIA
Relax. Rhonda lobotomized herself with facebook and Larry only cares about sex. They won't say a word unless they're told to.

MURRY

Cynthia. What do you want?

CYNTHIA

I *want* to expand my bathroom. But Valerie would never allow that.

MURRY

From me. What do you want from me?

Cynthia sets a thick legal document in front of Murry.

CYNTHIA

Accountability.

Phrases like DEFRAUDING INVESTORS and POSSIBLE LEGAL PENALTIES and UP-TO-AND-INCLUDING INCARCERATION.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - NIGHT

Sera parks in front of the Pyramid. Takes out the thumbdrive. Thinks. Finds a fruit rollup. Wraps the thumbdrive in the fruit rollup, then the wrapper. Shoves it back in her tote.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE A - NIGHT

Valerie opens the door for Sera. Checks both ways.

VALERIE

Where are the documents?

SERA

In my car. But the detectives, I told you, they don't care.

VALERIE

They don't know what they're looking at. But I can explain everything to them.

SERA

Why didn't you explain earlier?

VALERIE

You know why. I'm terrified of him. But together, we stand a chance.

Valerie takes her hands. It puts Sera at ease.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

Let's go. I'll come with you.

Valerie opens the door and heads out for the elevator.

Sera follows until she--

SNIFFS.

Turns to a bottle of perfume on the mantle.

From her pocket, Sera pulls out the bottle Murry left her.

It's the same bottle.

PENTHOUSE FLOOR

Valerie presses DOWN. Looks back to Sera, who's still inside.

VALERIE

Come on.

Elevator arrives with a DING. Triggering--

BARK BARK

Sera pokes her head out and looks at Penthouse B.

SERA

Is that him?

Valerie whispers, impatient:

VALERIE

No. He's not home.

SERA

(loud whisper)

Then why are you whispering?

Eye contact. Uh oh.

Sera SLAMS the door closed. LOCK.

Valerie races back to her locked door as--

Cynthia and Rhonda pour out to see what the commotion is.

VALERIE

Cynthia! The door!

PENTHOUSE B

Murry SLAMS the door from inside and LOCKS it. Looks back at Larry in his chair. Harmless. Then finds the master key. No one's getting in now.

BANG BANG BANG from the front door...

CYNTHIA (O.S.)
Let us in or we call the cops!

...and BANG BANG BANG from the glass door to the deck.

SERA (O.S.)
Nik Lamb! Let me in or I'm calling
the police!

He looks back and forth at the doors.

He's trapped. Until--

A CONCRETE PLANTER CRASHES through the window.

Sera CHARGES through the broken glass.

But Murry GRABS her from behind and covers her mouth. Spins her away from the mirrors so she doesn't see his face.

Sera drops her tote bag as she tries to strike him.

Snacks tries to jump at her and defend Murry. But he can't see! He's just lunging and biting the air.

LARRY

wheels to front door. Stretches to unlock it. Too high!

MURRY AND SERA

struggle as he tries to evade her gaze without hurting her.

Sera ELBOWS his stomach. But before she can see his face--

Snacks manages to scratch her leg, distracting her.

Murry runs out onto the deck.

Sera chases after...

...leaving Snacks with the tote-bag. Uh oh. He SNIFFS his way to the fruit rollup with the thumbdrive. Gobbles it up.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - CONTINUOUS

Sera stalks Murry onto the deck.

SERA
Nikos...

Shard of glass in her hand as she searches...

SERA
I just want to talk.

MURRY

hides behind the hedges on Valerie's side of the deck.

SERA (O.S.)
What happened to my brother?

Finally, in the REFLECTION of the WINDOW, he sees:

SERA approaching behind him.

SERA
Say something!

He looks up in the reflection. Eye contact.

MURRY
Please don't be mad.

SERA SCREAMS--

--steps backward in a panic...into the rusty railing--

--which JIGGLES but doesn't fall.

Still, her foot slips underneath and gets stuck between the railing and the edge.

Now, the railing teeters, about to drop her...

...until Murry GRABS HER ARM.

MURRY
Don't look down.

She looks back up at her brother's face and SCREAMS AGAIN.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Larry stretches long enough to unlock the front door.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Murry drags Sera back up safely on the roof.

SERA
(backing away)
This isn't real. You're dead.

MURRY
Just go to Valerie's. I'll slow
down the rest of the Board.

He hedges over toward Penthouse B.

SERA
I don't trust her--

MURRY
Then trust me!

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE A - CONTINUOUS

Sera races through the open door. Calls back outside:

SERA
Murry!

VALERIE (O.S.)
His name is Nik.

Valerie drives the dog's insulin NEEDLE into her neck.

She whispers in her ear as blood sugar crashes...

VALERIE (CONT'D)
And I'm finished sharing him.

...then lets Sera crash to the floor.

MURRY

races in moments later and finds:

Valerie tending to unconscious Sera. No needle in sight.

VALERIE
Cynthia must've stuck her with the
dog insulin. What happened in there?

MURRY
They know about me. And Nik.

VALERIE

Oh no. This is worse than I thought. We need to get that evidence before they do. Have you seen Sera's keys?

PRE-LAP: KNOCK KNOCK

PENTHOUSE B

Cynthia slowly opens the door--

VALERIE SLAMS THROUGH IT, knocking Cynthia to floor.

VALERIE

Find me the car keys.

Valerie grabs the cane before it falls.

CYNTHIA

He didn't sign yet.

VALERIE

I know that, you insect.

(pressing cane to Cynthia)

That's why we need to destroy those files immediately.

(releasing her)

Until he takes responsibility, Pharaoh is still in our name.

RHONDA

...your name, technically.

Valerie SMACKS Rhonda with the cane. OW.

VALERIE

This is a co-operative, Rhonda. We need to cooperate. If I go down--

(pinning her with cane)

I'm dragging you with me.

PENTHOUSE A

Murry rubs honey on Sera's gums.

After a bit, her eyes flutter. But she's not fully conscious. And she doesn't have energy to scream. Just musters:

SERA

I saw you die.

MURRY
That was Murry--

SERA
You killed him.

She's barely conscious. Trying hard to focus.

MURRY
Sera. He was a bad person.

SERA
What does that make you?

Before Murry can process this, he hears a CREAK.

Murry puts a finger to his lips. Then slips out onto the deck to check who's there...

...but that's not where the sound came from...

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - NIGHT

Murry carefully approaches Penthouse B.

Waits beside the glass door to watch the shadows. Just as he turns to peek, he hears--

SERA YELLING.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE A - NIGHT

Murry races back in and finds:

Sera's hands, legs, and mouth taped up. She's going nuts. Mumbling indecipherably--

MURRY
What is it?

SERA
(mumbling through tape)
Pharaoh!

AN INSULIN NEEDLE STICKS Murry in the neck--

VALERIE (O.S.)
It's nothing personal, Nikki.

Valerie catches him in her arms from behind. Eye contact.

VALERIE
It's just Manhattan.

She lets his body drop onto the floor.

PRE-LAP: FIRE RIPPLES

VALERIE (PRE-LAP)
 Nik?

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - NIGHT

The Co-Op Board is gathered before a roaring fireplace.
 Valerie tries waking up Murry, who's tied up in a chair.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
 Nik?

SERA (O.S.)
 That's not his name.

VALERIE
 Oh. Nik isn't a person, darling.

Sera's tied up next to Murry, who's eyes flutter open.

VALERIE (CONT'D)
 Nik is a job.
 (beat)
 A job he's been doing quite well
 since his predecessor resigned.

MURRY
 What the fuck is going on?

VALERIE
 It's been two weeks, Nik. We have a
 meeting scheduled.
 (collegially)
 Now, I understand our dispute
 seems...intractable. But this board
 always finds a compromise.

SERA
 She wants you to go to prison for
 her. That's what this is.

CYNTHIA
 Oh he's going to prison. The only
 question is for what.

RHONDA
 And for who!

VALERIE

Shut up, Rhonda.

(back to Murry, smile)

And no one is going to *prison*. This is the Upper East Side. Nik has excellent attorneys. Worst case: six months in Camp Cupcake playing bocci with Madoff. Then back home.

SERA

You can't be considering this.

(off his silence)

Murry. *She* is Pharaoh. The files incriminate her, not Nik. He stole them so he could escape.

VALERIE

I don't see any files.

Larry tries to say something. But he can't.

VALERIE (CONT'D)

The truth is up to you now.

SERA

He won't do this.

Murry looks down. Valerie gently pulls his chin up.

VALERIE

Yes. He will.

SERA

No he won't.

MURRY

I will.

Sera turns to Murry. What.

SERA

Murry--

MURRY

My name is Nik.

(to the board)

And I'll pay you back. I'll sign whatever you want. But you need to know I didn't kill anyone.

SERA

Then tell the truth. And come home.

MURRY

This is home. If Murry's alive,
he's a murderer.

SERA

At least he's a real person. With
family. Who can prove he exists.

A long silence. Murry looks around.

MURRY

Two weeks ago, I was opening doors.
And even if I wanted to, there's no
way back down.

SERA

You fucking idiot.

VALERIE

(snatching Sera's mouth)
You don't get to talk to him like
that anymore. The days of you
looking down on him are over.

Sera BITES Valerie's hand. OW! Then barks at Murry:

SERA

Listen to me. Don't sign anything.
That drive is here somewhere.

But Larry's going nuts.

VALERIE

Larry settle down.

CYNTHIA

No. Let him talk.

RHONDA

He can't!

But he *can* point. And he slowly lifts his finger to...

Snacks, who BARKS. Sticky redness on his mouth.

VALERIE

Larry. Did the dog eat the evidence?

Larry stares at the guilty dog. Yes!!!

MURRY

No.

VALERIE

We're going to need that back.

Valerie hones in on Snacks...who can't see her coming.

MURRY

Snacks, run!

Confused and panicked, Snacks can smell Valerie closing in.

He runs off, bumping into walls...then finding his way through the broken window.

VALERIE

Get him Rhonda! Or it'll be you in
Larry's chair.

Rhonda reluctantly complies as Valerie races after Snacks.

CYNTHIA

No. This building is dog friendly!

Valerie and Rhonda chase him out onto the deck.

Murry tries to get up. But he can't. Looks up at Cynthia:

MURRY

Please. Don't let her hurt him. Ms.
Wax, listen. We can make a deal.

CYNTHIA

Nikos. You've already made one.

Murry turns to Sera. She can't even look at him.

But then he SNIFFS--

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Valerie chases Snacks around. Rhonda's hesitant.

RHONDA

Can't we just wait for him to poop?

VALERIE

You want me to risk my freedom for
a dog's fecal schedule? Get him!

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - SAME

Murry SNIFFS again in Sera's direction.

MURRY

Sera. Is that what I think it is?

She turns away. Doesn't even want to look at him.

MURRY (CONT'D)

Abla. Parfüm var mi?

She stunned.

MURRY

I made it for my sister.

Sera can move her hand just enough to reach into her pocket and pull out the bottle of perfume by the cap.

SERA

Does Nik even have a sister?

MURRY

Yeah. She's a fucking psycho.

Murry nods to the fire. But she doesn't understand.

MURRY

A control freak who always tells him what to do. But god forbid anyone ever tells *her* what to do! She'd rather set the room on fire than be constrained in any way!

Sera looks at ropes on her wrists. Then the perfume.

MURRY

Do you even like it?

SNIFF.

SERA

It smells like shit.

She drops the bottle.

It tumbles in front of her feet...

...Murry KICKS it into the fire.

CYNTHIA

What did you just do?

But nothing happens. Murry and Sera exchange a look. Failure.

SERA

Nothing.

MURRY

No, Sera. You were right.

The perfume bottle starts melting...

MURRY (CONT'D)

It's cheap plastic bullshit.

...leaking flammable liquid drips into the embers...

The fireplace SPRAYS FIRE!

Flames crawl across the hardwood toward Murry's chair.

He rocks. Once. Twice.

CRASHES sideways to the floor.

The impact splits his lip on the hardwood. Blood on his chin.

But now his bound wrists are inches from the spreading fire.

Sera SCREAMS as flames lick his arms.

SERA

Stop it!

He doesn't stop. Pushes his wrists deeper. Skin blistering.
The smell of burning rope and flesh.

The rope SMOLDERS...then SNAPS.

Murry rolls away. Gasping. Hands raw and trembling.

He PUSHES himself off the floor. Unties Sera.

She turns away from him.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - CONTINUOUS

Murry bursts out to find Valerie with Snacks in her arms by the railing. SQUEEZING him tight.

MURRY

Put him down.

VALERIE

When I'm finished. He still has
something that belongs to me.

(to Snacks)

Don't make me cut it out of you.

Snacks VOMITS in her face.

Valerie DROPS the dog. Then drops to her knees to look for the thumbdrive.

But Murry scoops it up.

VALERIE
Give it to me, Nikki.

Murry doesn't budge.

VALERIE
I'll make it all worth it. I
promise. I know we've made bad
choices. But all we can do now is
make those choices right. Right?

MURRY
You're right.

Oh thank god! She rushes in to hug him.

MURRY
And I know it's not personal.

She exhales. It never was! But--

MURRY
It's just Manhattan.

He pushes her back--

She trips backward over the disoriented Snacks--

Falls into the rusty railing--

But the railing holds...

...for a moment of eye contact. She reaches for his hand--

HINGES SNAP!

Murry scoops Snacks into his arms as--

Valerie drops backward over the edge...

...plummets 22 stories...

...SPLAT.

LOCAL NEWS (PRE-LAP)
Mayhem at the Pyramid House uptown
Monday after the suicide of Co-Op
Board Co-President, Valerie Muller.

EXT. STREET - DAY

SIRENS BLARE as Sera stumbles out of the back exit.

LOCAL NEWS (PRE-LAP)(CONT'D)
Board Members report confronting
Ms. Muller with evidence of a multi-
year financial conspiracy, after
which she set fire to a neighbor's
apartment and took her own life.

Disoriented, she finds her car.

LOCAL NEWS (PRE-LAP)(CONT'D)
Authorities now indicate a
connection with the death of
doorman Murat Oğan last month.

INT./EXT. SERA'S CAR - NIGHT (SOME TIME LATER)

REVEAL the LOCAL NEWS on YouTube on a phone.

LOCAL NEWS (ON PHONE)(CONT'D)
In an exclusive interview, new Board
President Cynthia Wax tells Channel
6 how Ms. Muller ruled the Pyramid
with an iron fist. Using the co-op
investment fund as a personal piggy
bank while blackmailing neighbor Nik
Lamb into accepting liability for
the entire scheme.

Cynthia appears in the shot.

CYNTHIA (ON PHONE)
Nikki didn't do anything wrong. He
was scared of her. We all were.
Maybe if we were braver, Murry
would still be alive.

Sera parks in front of the Pyramid.

LOCAL NEWS (ON PHONE)
Multiple tenants now say Ms.
Muller's reign of terror prevented
them from coming forward earlier
with the truth: that she pushed the
24-year-old off her penthouse deck
after being confronted with
evidence of her crimes.

She looks out the window. Up at the building.

LOCAL NEWS (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 Mr. Lamb, meanwhile, plans to
 settle with the victims and the SEC
 for an undisclosed amount, and is
 expected to avoid criminal charges.

To the top.

EXT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE DECK - SAME

Murry looks down at Sera.

LOCAL NEWS (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 He could not be reached for comment.

Then watches her drive away.

INT. PYRAMID - PENTHOUSE B - CONTINUOUS

Snacks BARKS!

Murry walks back into the penthouse.

Closes the glass door behind him.

In the reflection, he sees Nik.

Nik smiles.

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THE END

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